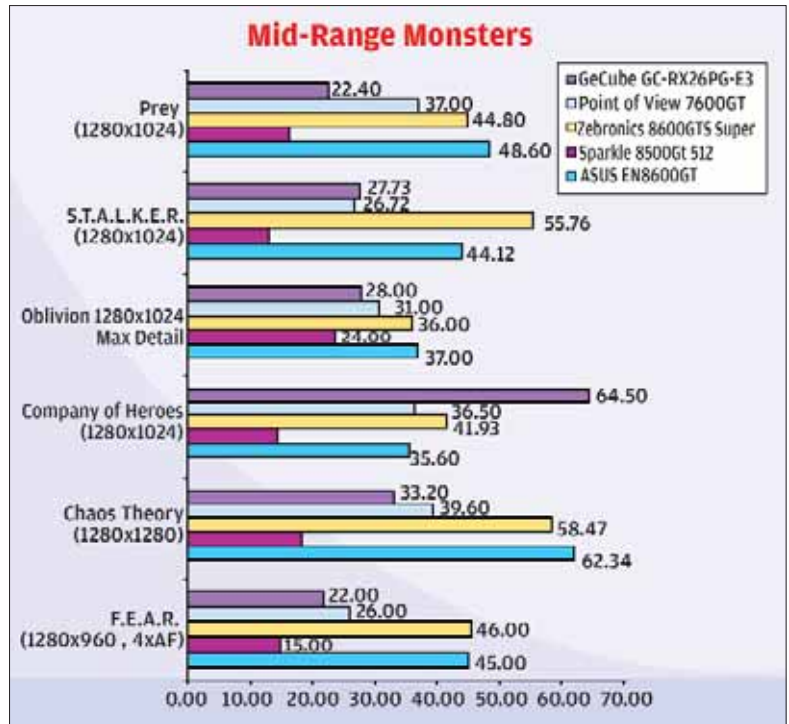


you're sure to find something here. DX 10 makes an appearance in more affordable territory with NVIDIA's GeForce 8500/8600 series and ATI's HD2600 series. Some of the older NVIDIA cards also linger—the 7600 series. Let's not waste any more time: 30 cards vie to make your pocket anywhere between Rs 4,110 and Rs 14,700 lighter!

Now That's A Crowd!

We saw a multitude of cards from ASUS—10 to exact. The EN8600GTS Silent is a heatpipe-based solution, and will draw a second glance—it seems fanless solutions are hot (pun intended!). The ASUS EN8600GT OC Gear actually comes with a 3.5-inch bat solution that has a twist knob for overclocking. Besides looking cool, it's totally functional—no more messy BIOS overclocking, although to be able to really overclock, you will need to get into the BIOS and tweak, since the module only allows a limited overclock of 10 per cent. Considering that the core is already at 540 MHz, this translates to a cool (or hot) 50+ MHz overclock at the simple twist of a knob!

The Zebtronics 8600GTS Super has this huge heatsink with fins that resemble the fan blades on a turbine. However, most of the 8600GT cards do not have active cooling for memory chips. The newer ATI RV630-based (a.k.a. Radeon HD2600 Pro) cards have quite an efficient single-slot cooling solution—based on a 65nm manufacturing process, these cores run quite cool (unlike their bigger brother, the HD2900XT).



This time round, none of the manufacturers were skimpy while bundling connectors—a trend we hope becomes a norm, considering such connectors don't cost much anyway. Gigabyte takes the initiative and bundles good games with both their cards—*Supreme Commander* with the GV-NX86T256D and *Warhammer 40000: Dark Crusade* with the GV-NX85T256H.

Another trend we've seen and would like to comment on is the trick of using

Parameters	8600GTS	8600GT	8500GT	HD2600	7600GT	7600GS
No Of Transistors (million)	289	289	210	390	177	177
Core speed (MHz)	675	540	450	600	560	450
Number of Shader units	32	32	16	120	12(PS)+5(VS)*	12(PS)+5(VS)*
Memory Bandwidth (GBps)	32	22.4	12.8	22.4	22.4	14.4

*PS= Pixel Shader, VS= Vertex Shader

The MSI RX2900XT VT2D512-E, HD-ready, with its bundle. Connectors, converters, cables galore!

